

Problem 2

Problem 1 The velocity of an object moving along a straight line is given by $v(t)$ (in ft/s) and we only know the following: $\int_0^3 v(t) dt = -3$, and $\int_3^4 v(t) dt = 5$.

Compute the following displacements, if possible. If it is not possible, give examples explaining why not.

(a) $s(3) - s(0)$

Explanation.

$$s(3) - s(0) = \int_0^3 v(t) dt = -3 \text{ ft}$$

(b) $s(4) - s(0)$

Explanation. First notice that

$$s(4) - s(0) = \int_0^4 v(t) dt$$

Therefore,

$$s(4) - s(0) = \int_0^3 v(t) dt + \int_3^4 v(t) dt = -3 + 5 = 2 \text{ ft}$$

(c) Find the displacement during the interval $[0, 4]$ if the velocity at the time t , $0 \leq t \leq 4$, was $v(t) + 2$ ft/s instead?

Explanation. In that case, we would have that

$$s(4) - s(0) = \int_0^4 (v(t) + 2) dt = \int_0^4 v(t) dt + \int_0^4 2 dt$$

We use the result in part (b) for the first integral, and geometry for the second interval.

$$s(4) - s(0) = 2 + 2(4 - 0) = 2 + 8 = 10 \text{ ft}$$

(d) Find the displacement during the interval $[0, 4]$ if the velocity at the time t , $0 \leq t \leq 4$, was $5v(t)$ ft/s instead?

Explanation. $s(4) - s(0) = \int_0^4 5v(t) dt = 5 \int_0^4 v(t) dt = 5(2) = 10 \text{ ft}$